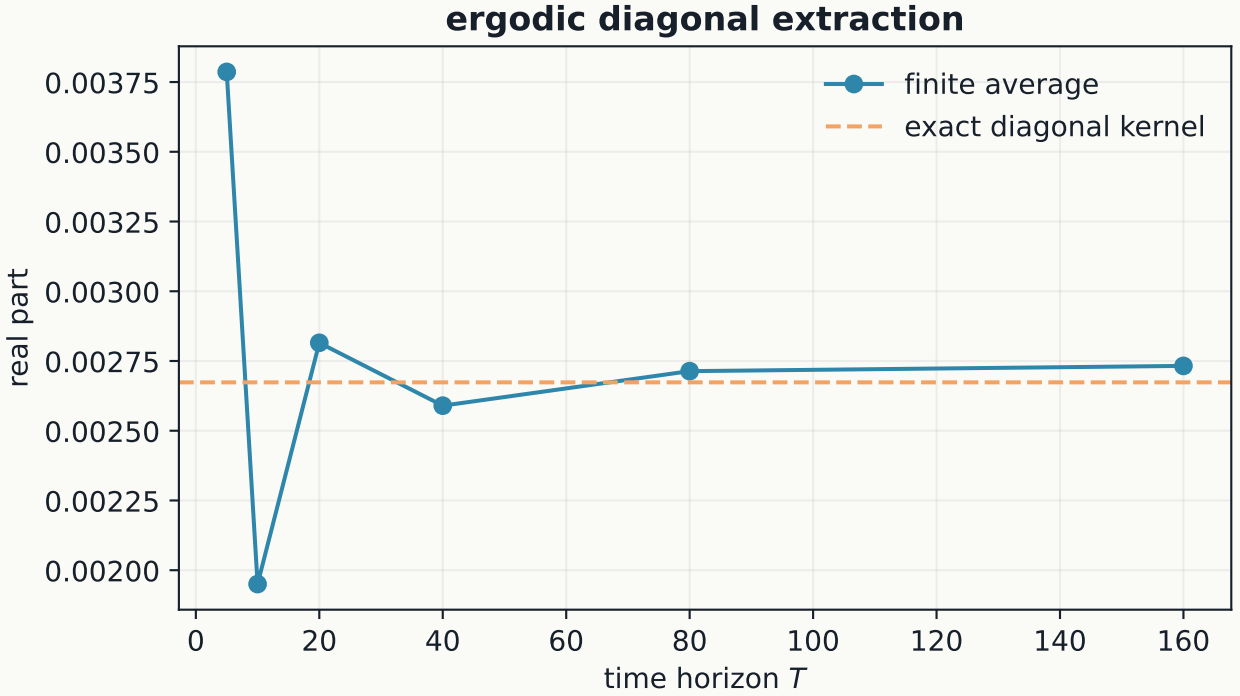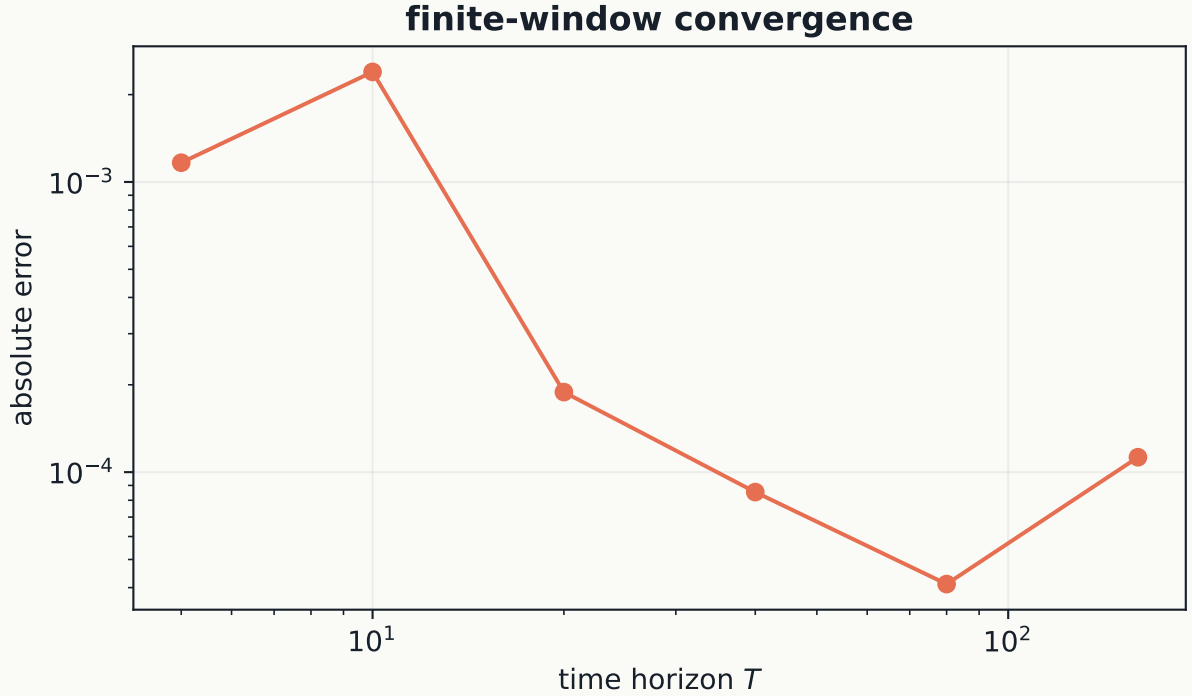The positive kernel is the long-time autocorrelation of the signed signal